

Village of Saranac Lake

Project Category: Waterfront Access and Amenities

J - Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park Improvements

Project Description

Implementation of the Park's Vision Plan at William Wallace Park (Saranac Lake Village Beach) include improved multimodal access to William Wallace Park as well as improvements within the park itself. Improved connections to the park include the conversion of an existing vehicular drive (access off Lake Colby Dr.) to a pedestrian trail connection, laying the connective foundation to a future walkway (along Lake Colby Drive) connecting to the Town of Harrietstown James A. Latour Park. The vehicular park entrance and exit will be relocated to Moir Drive and include an improved parking area and signage, enhancing visibility of the park. Internal improvements to William Wallace Park include a new, year-round, and universally accessible Beach Pavilion, bathrooms, and entry plaza, with seasonal portable toilets proposed short term. Other internal improvements include, addressing drainage issues, a fenced children's play area with equipment, bike racks, trash receptacles, an improved beach area, and a universally accessible hand boat launch with parking area, seasonal non-motorized boat rentals, and access for ice fishing.

Project Location

Northwest of the Village of Saranac Lake on Broadway, cornered by Broadway and Moir Road. Access to Lake Colby.

Conceptual Design or Other Graphic



LWRP Policies

Policy 1: Restore, revitalize, and redevelop deteriorated and underutilized waterfront areas for commercial, industrial, cultural, recreational, and other compatible uses.

Policy 2: Facilitate the siting of water dependent uses and facilities on or adjacent to coastal water.

Policy 9: Expand recreational use of fish and wildlife resources in coastal areas by increasing access to existing resources, supplementing existing stocks, and developing new resources.

Policy 19: Protect, maintain, and increase the level and types of access to public water related recreation resources and facilities.

Policy 20: Access to the publicly-owned foreshore and to lands immediately adjacent to the foreshore or the water's edge that are publicly-owned shall be provided and it shall be provided in a manner compatible with adjoining uses.

Policy 21: Water dependent and water enhanced recreation will be encouraged and facilitated, and will be given priority over non-water-related uses along the coast.

Policy 22: Development when located adjacent to the shore will provide for water-related recreation whenever such use is compatible with reasonably anticipated demand for such activities and is compatible with the primary purpose of the development.

Policy 23: Protect, enhance and restore structures, districts, areas or sites that are of significance in the history, architecture, archaeology or culture of the State, its communities, or the Nation.

Policy 25: Protect, restore or enhance natural and man-made resources which are not identified as being of statewide significance, but which contribute to the overall scenic quality of the coastal area.

Cost Estimate for Implementing the Project

Preliminary design for Lake Colby Beach/William Wallace Park improvements was completed as part of the Parks Vision Plan in 2018. Design elements were further refined for the LWRP.

Project Element	Approximate Costs
Final Design and Permitting	\$266,000
Site Preparation	\$80,000
Facility Construction and Furnishings	\$1,100,750
Mobilization, Bonds & Contingency	\$390,750
TOTAL	\$ 1,837,500

Potential Funding Sources

- NYS Consolidated Funding Application grants

Benefits

- Improve multimodal access to park with short term/long term planning
- Provide improved public lake access for swimming, boating, and fishing
- Universal accessibility of park and amenities
- Enhance visitor experience through amenity improvements including four season features
- Activation of public space
- Water quality improvements to Lake Flower

Timeframe

Undetermined.

Regulatory Requirements

May require regulatory coordination with the NYS Department of Health (DOH).